Saints Memory

A matching game for young children — Ages 4-7 — 2-4 Players — 15 Minutes

Age Range	Players	Play Time	Difficulty
4-7	**2-4**	**15 minutes**	**Easy**

About This Game

Saints Memory introduces young children to twelve beloved saints of the Coptic Orthodox Church. By matching each saint to their symbol, children build familiarity with the saints who pray for us and watch over us from heaven.

> **Formation Goal:** Building early familiarity and love for the saints as friends and intercessors.

Components

- **12 Saint Cards** — each showing a saint's name, title, and dates
- **12 Symbol Cards** — each showing the saint's traditional symbol with a hint

Setup

1. Print the card sheets on cardstock (110 lb recommended).
2. Cut along the card borders. You should have 24 cards total.
3. Shuffle all 24 cards together.
4. Lay the cards face-down in a grid (6 columns × 4 rows works well).

How to Play

1. The youngest player goes first.
2. On your turn, flip over any two cards so everyone can see them.
3. **If the cards match** (a saint and their symbol): keep the pair, place it in front of you, and take another turn.
4. **If the cards do not match**: flip them back face-down, and the next player goes.
5. Continue until all pairs are found.
6. The player with the most pairs wins!

Matching Pairs

Each saint matches with one symbol card:

- **St. Mary** — The Mother holding the Christ Child
- **St. George** — A knight slaying a dragon
- **St. Mark** — A lion beside a Gospel book
- **St. Anthony** — A desert cave and a monk's hood
- **St. Mina** — Two camels kneeling
- **St. Demiana** — A crown of flowers and a cross
- **St. Philopateer Mercurius** — Two swords crossed
- **St. Moses the Black** — A transformed heart and a shining light
- **St. Marina** — A flame and a praying figure
- **Archangel Michael** — A shield and a bright star
- **St. Abraam of Fayoum** — Bread given to the poor
- **St. Bishoy** — Christ washing feet

Tips for Parents and Teachers

- For very young children (ages 3-4), start with only 6 pairs (12 cards) to keep the game short.

- When a pair is matched, say the saint's name together and ask: "Can you say, 'St. [Name], pray for us'?"
- Point out the saints' icons in church next time you visit.
- Play on feast days to celebrate the saint being commemorated.

Variants

- **Cooperative mode:** Instead of competing, work together to find all pairs. Count how many flips it takes and try to beat your record next time.
- **Storytelling mode:** When a pair is matched, the adult briefly tells the saint's story before continuing.
- **Speed match:** For older children, lay all cards face-up and race to find pairs as fast as possible.

> *"Therefore we also, since we are surrounded by so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which so easily ensnares us, and let us run with endurance the race that is set before us."* — Hebrews 12:1